version, etc.). If we don't want all the metadata but just the original source, re-run the query by changing the _doc endpoint with _source: `GET books/_source/1`.

RETRIEVING MULTIPLE DOCUMENTS BY ID

When we need to retrieve a set of documents given a set of identifiers, we can use an `ids` query. The query fetches the documents given a set of document IDs. It's a much simpler way to fetch them all at once, given a list of document IDs.

One thing to note, though, is that unlike other queries that use document APIs to fetch documents, the `ids` query uses a search API—specifically, a `_search` endpoint. Let's see that in action.

> **NOTE** Elasticsearch provides a domain specific language (DSL) for writing queries, commonly called Query DSL. It is a simple JSON-based query writing language, extensively used to write queries in Kibana. Most queries in this chapter (and the rest of the book) are based on Query DSL.

Listing 2.5 Fetching multiple documents using an `ids` query

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "ids": {
      "values": [1,2,3]
    }
  }
}
```

The request body in the query is constructed using a `query` object, which has an inner object named `ids`. The document IDs are the values provided in the query as an array. The response indicates the successful hits (results), as shown in figure 2.11, returning the three documents with those IDs.

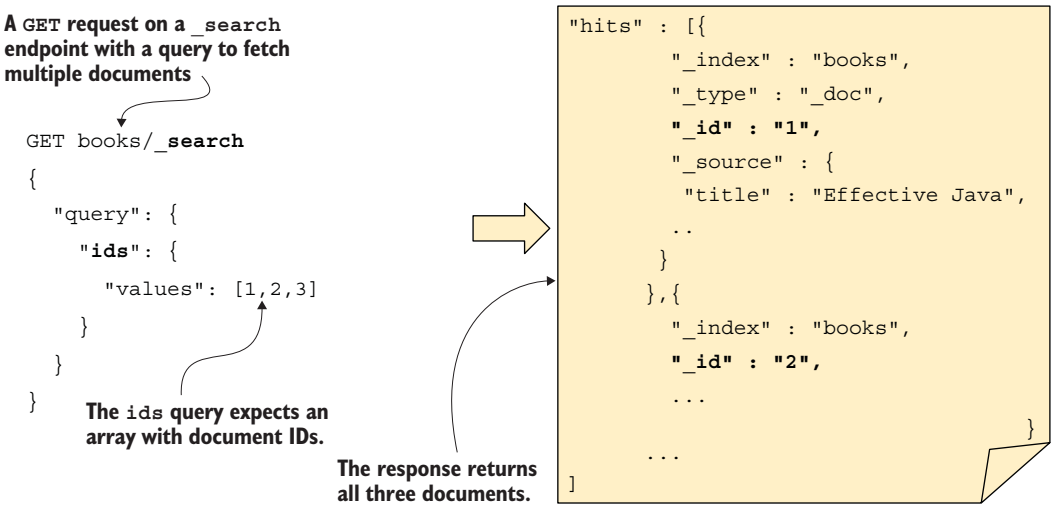


Figure 2.11 Retrieving documents with a set of IDs using an `ids` query, which invokes a `_search` endpoint